NCCP 00621 · VERSION 3

Paclitaxel · Days 1, 8 and 15 of 28

Paclitaxel 80 mg/m² on Days 1, 8 and 15 of each 28-day cycle. Day 22 is a planned week off, not a fourth routine dose. Continue according to benefit and tolerance. The NCCP indications are off-label in Ireland and require the local consent / approval process.

Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Selected effects; not a complete medicine leaflet.

A picture of side effects

Numbered symptom boxes connect to the anatomical illustration. The medicine responsible may be uncertain; report the symptom.

1 Hands / feet

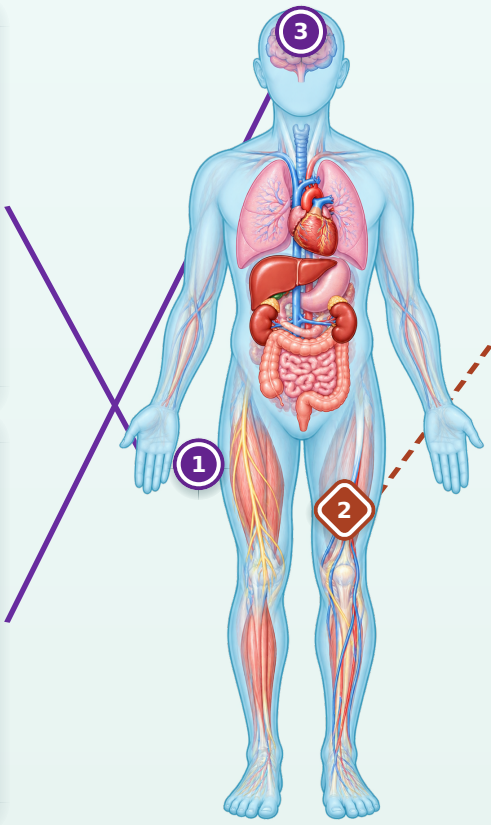
Paclitaxel

Report numbness or tingling before the next dose.

3 Hair / scalp

Chemotherapy phase

Hair loss is common. Ask about scalp cooling before treatment where suitable.



2 Blood / infection

Chemotherapy phase

Fever, shivers or suddenly unwell: call immediately.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Selected medicine-specific effects; the full risk discussion includes hair loss, fertility and other individual risks.

> Fever, shivers or suddenly unwell: contact oncology immediately. Severe chest pain, breathing difficulty, collapse or seizure: 112 / 999.

Your treatment, at home.

Important medicine-specific effects

Paclitaxel

- Low blood counts and infection
- Numbness / tingling, sometimes lasting
- Hair loss, muscle or joint pain
- Infusion reaction
- Mouth, bowel, skin and nail effects

Surgery, radiation and monitoring: open the whole-treatment map or scan the QR.

Make the plan practical

The correct phase prescription

Taxanes use low-risk antiemetic support; hypersensitivity premedication is a separate requirement.

Premedicines and growth factors

Paclitaxel premedicines differ between weekly and fortnightly dosing. Use the phase-specific prescription.

Tests and appointments

The team should name the booking owner, due window and person reviewing each required test. Tell them if an expected appointment has not arrived.

After chemotherapy

Discuss recovery, fertility, rehabilitation and the next treatment or surveillance step.

Review the full medicine plan

First-dose NCCP suggested premedication: dexamethasone 8 mg IV, chlorphenamine 10 mg IV and famotidine 20 mg IV 30 minutes before paclitaxel. From Day 8, dexamethasone may be omitted in the source suggested table; add or modify for increased risk or previous reaction under consultant guidance. Famotidine omission is also a consultant/local-policy decision requiring close observation. The conventional paclitaxel product information has a different generic premedication regimen. Reconcile the exact product, weekly NCCP pathway and local policy; never self-omit premedication. Low emetic risk; keep the antiemetic plan separate from reaction premedication. Consider analgesia for myalgia/arthralgia and early action on neuropathy.

Emergency: 112 / 999. Severe breathing difficulty, collapse, seizure or severe chest pain needs emergency help.

Contact oncology immediately for temperature ≥37.5°C or ≤36°C, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your own hospital's instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment.

YOUR ONCOLOGY TEAM · DAYTIME

Insert numbers here

Acute Oncology Service

YOUR ONCOLOGY TEAM · OUT OF HOURS

Insert numbers here

Ask for medical oncology

EVENINGS / OVERNIGHT

Your out-of-hours pathway / nearest ED

Other hospitals: use the numbers your team provides.

Complete reference, visual timeline and passport

https://sactcheck.com/patient/00621/

Sources and review status are available online. Follow your own prescription and hospital instructions.